

MODULE III:

EFFECTIVE WRITING

“This Module is designed to help the students come-up with effective Writing, effective application letter, resume and other business letter in their Workplace”



ALMAR T. DELA CRUZ

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CHAPTER I: Introduction

What is Effective Writing?

Effective Writing is one of the channels of communication in written form which has a logical flow of ideas. Sentences are link to paragraphs and paragraphs are links to the entire composition, thus certain technical aspect of writing must be considered.

Written outputs become effective when it captures the reader's attention where message was clearly sent or received by the target receiver.

Technical writing skills are vital to consider in effective writing. It includes simplicity of the chosen word, cohesion of sentences and clarity and other technical writing aspects.



The purpose of Effective writing can be categorized into four such as:

1. **Expressive Writing**- it aims to connect others and to contribute to human thought and culture by means of "expressing".
e.g. Expressing thoughts through different social media accounts
2. **Informative writing**- this is used to educate or to explain something to its intended audience. It is clear, accurate, organized and fair.
e.g. Research paper, Essay and presentation
3. **Persuasive writing**- its goal is to change the minds of the reader or at least to get the reader to ask question, in addition it aims to convince its reader.
e.g. Application letter and other business letters
4. **Literary Work**- It is more on entertainment purposes as product of creative writing.
e.g. Novels, Poems, Blogs, eBooks.

Qualities of Effective Writing

Various characteristics or qualities of effective writing can be identified, however these qualities/characteristics can be group into the following traits:

Ideas- the written output must present interesting and factual information about the topic being presented. The message or the purpose of the message must clear enough to understand that hold the reader's attention.

Organization- Presentation of sentences that supports the idea must well organize. Each main and sub point is arranged according to the best pattern of organization. Good writing has a clear developed beginning, middle and ending.

Voice- It pertains to the writer's unique way of expressing the ideas that hold reader's attention; the impact of the written output can be influence by how it was presented that gives writing personality.

Word Choice- A writer who is knowledgeable in terms of language used has can create an effective written output, words must be chosen according to its appropriate use The correct used of words helps to developed effective communication. Words must be aligned with the intended audience/reader.

Sentence Fluency- Effective writing flows smoothly and clear from one sentence to the next.

CHAPTER II: Writing Effective Application Letter

Application letter also known as *cover letter* is an example of business communication document that expresses your interest in an open job position. It explains who the applicant is as professional and as an individual. It highlights the achievement and skills of an applicant that proves that he/she is fit to the role.

A well written application letter impresses potential employer that set you apart from other applicant. It takes extra credit for you as applicant. Expressing your familiarity with the company and your desire job through application letter is a best tool for the making a well written application letter.

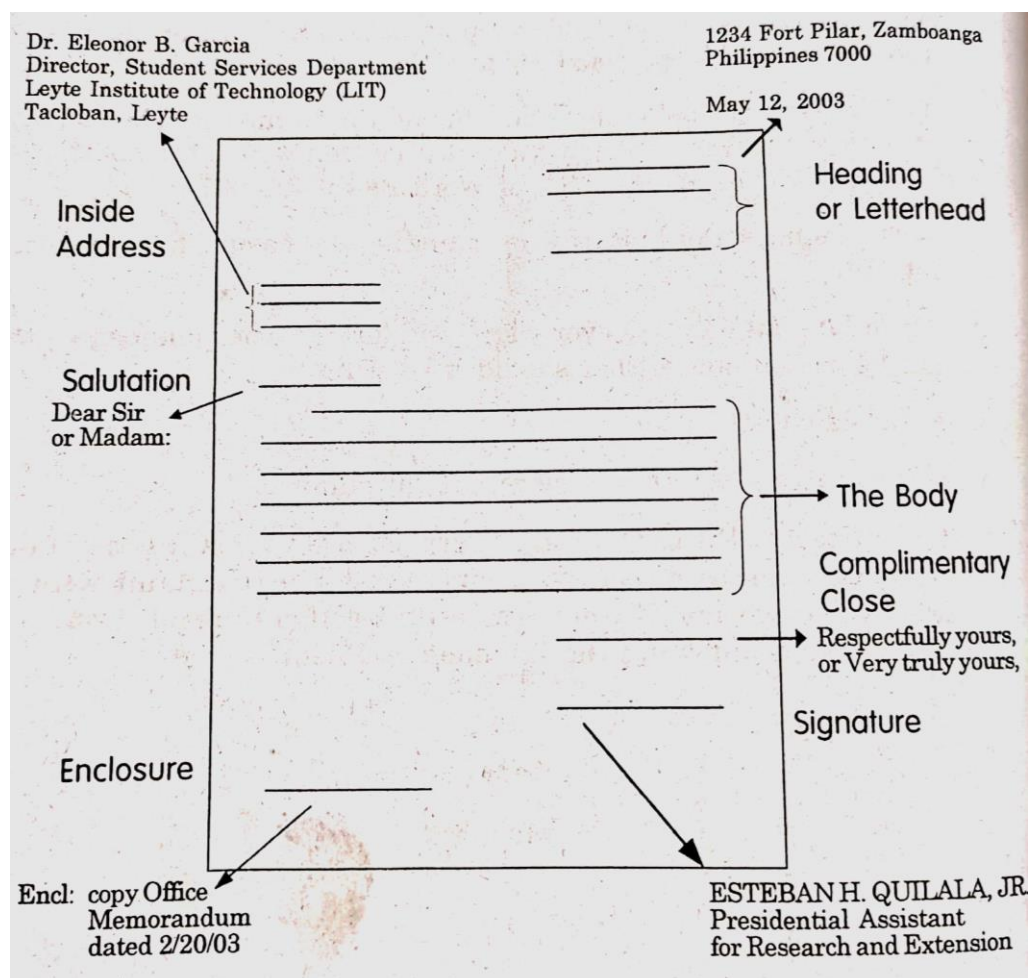
Something to consider in the development of your application letter

1. *Emphasize your skills and abilities.* This is an opportunities where to sell yourself as candidate for the position, citing your job experiences where you applied skills may highlight your application.
2. *Stay Concise.* Too much detailed information weakens your application. A brief and concise letter is more manageable and appealing.

3. *Proofread the letter.* Identify errors that create negative impression can be avoid through proofreading. Your application letter must be free from any error.
4. *Review the job listing keyword.* Hiring manager includes certain skills and abilities to be look over. As an applicant mentioning it to your cover letter may give additional merit.
5. *Be innovative and adaptive.* Integration of technology in your application is one thing to be considered. A computerized application letter is more appealing compare from a hand-written application letter.

Parts of an Application Letter

The basic part of Application letter is exactly the same with the other business letters, regardless of its purpose.



The Heading

It consist of the writer's complete address (includes city and Zip code) arranged in block form and placed at the upper right corner of the letter. Abbreviations are not used in the heading.

e.g. 1234 Fort Pilar, Zamboanga
Philippines 7000

May 12, 2003

Inside Address

It includes the following details.

1. Recipient's name and title, the name of the office or department, if any, the name of the company or institution and the street address city or zip code.
2. Use block form, aligned with the one above.
3. The inside address should be set flushed with the left-hand margin, four lines below the heading.
4. Include the Proper title of the recipient.
5. Use a separate line if the job title is too long.

e.g. **Mr. DENNIS D. SY**
General Manager
Sweet Corn Food Corporation
Malate, Manila, Philippines

The Salutation

This serve as a simple greeting of the letter.

1. Place the salutation two lines below the inside address.
2. End the salutation with colon.
3. Address the recipient with his/her appropriate title and his/her late name.
4. Some applicant use neutral salutation specially when the recipient is unknown, however, it will be great if the applicant has the knowledge about the receiver.

e.g. Dear Mr. Sy:

The Body

This serves as the meat of the letter. It contains the message.

1. Write the body two lines below the salutation
2. When using block style, do not indent paragraphs but always keep two spaces between paragraphs.
3. Your intention must be clearly stated and the message must be presented clearly as mention from the previous chapter.

The Complementary Close

These are words that end the letter.

1. Words such as; Sincerely yours, Respectfully yours, Yours truly, Cordially yours, Very truly yours are appropriate for business letter.
2. Place this part two line below the body of the letter.
3. Align this with the heading or with the left hand margin.

e.g. Sincerely yours,

Signature

This place four lines below the complimentary close.

1. Type your name in capital letter.
2. Include your position (identity as the writer) below your name.
3. Use official ink for your signature over the printed name

Some business letter include "letter Enclosure". This is used when you are enclosing something to your letter.

Purpose of Application Letter/ Cover Letter

It serves as the first contact of the applicant to the prospective employer. IT serves as introduction of the applicant's background experience. Most of the time application letter or cover letter is attached from applicant resume. The cover letter is marketing tool that communicates to the employer. Sometimes, a well-written cover letter can be more effective that resume itself.

CHAPTER III: Writing Impressive Resume/Curriculum Vitae

RESUME

It is a formal document that creates by the applicant that itemizes his or her qualification for the position; it is usually accompanied by customized cover letter which applicant expresses his intent.

American job coaches insist that a resume should be only one or two pages in length. British job applicants traditionally are expected to produce a somewhat more detailed document, called a CV (curriculum vitae).

Purpose

A resume is almost always required for applicants to white-collar positions. They are the first step taken by corporate recruiters and hiring managers to identify candidates who might be invited to interview for a position.

Characteristics of a Resume

A good resume is characterized by lively-action-oriented where reflect the applicant's unique personalities and abilities. The data to be included in a resume must be relevant, concise and up-to-date. To achieve these, the following may be considered:

Professional Looking

A computerized resume is more advantageous, it follows some basic considerations like the font style and size as a standard. Bullet points are more apt to be read than long blocks of text. Remember that the resume should not duplicate your cover letter, and most importantly it must be free from any error to create a positive first impression.

Education and Honors

Listing of your educational background substantiates your credentials and adding special recognition from your previous achievements strengthens your resume.

Work Experience (if any)

Mentioning your previous works is a merit for an applicant that may sound interesting to the employers, for your experience can be useful to your desired job.

Skills and Interest

Elaborating your skills makes you unique as an applicant. You may mention your skills that might become useful as an employee.

According to Sundberg Jorgen the following 10 Features must be included in a Resume:

• Communication Skills	• Commitment
• Openness	• Enthusiasm
• Creativity	• Integrity
• Cultural Experience	• Team Spirit
• Positivity	• Community Service

Parts of Resume

Many references suggest various parts and template of resume, however, the best resume that could be done is the one that personally designed.

In general sense, a resume will include the following:

Header

It includes the applicant's details such as: name, full address, phone number and email. This is where the employers get it touch to the applicant. This means the data to be included here must be updated and factual. Inclusion of personal photo may strengthen applicant's identity.

Professional Objective (optional)

Even this is optional, still indicating applicant's objective is importance for it shows career direction of applicant. In addition, it highlights applicant's intentions and accomplishment. It is good to state key qualification instead of personal preferences.

Qualifications Summary (optional)

This typically includes your years of experience, technology proficiency, languages and highest achievements.

Education

This part give details on the educational information of the applicant, This includes the school affiliation, the degree and sometimes recognition/ awards/received.

Experience

This category typically reflects your contact with specific employers. Include co-ops, internships, part-time, jobs, volunteer work, summer jobs, special projects or military experience under this category. You do not need to include all of your previous jobs, only those that relate to the position you are seeking.

References

Generally references are not listed on a resume and only provided if requested by an employer. To share your references, list in alphabetical order the names, titles, addresses, telephone numbers and e-mail addresses of at least three people on a separate page. Include your contact information in a format consistent with your resume in the event that your resume and reference list are separated. People who have known you for at least a year and within a context similar to the position you are seeking will provide the strongest endorsements. Faculty are often your best source of references since they have assessed the knowledge, skills and abilities that employers are often seeking.

CHAPTER IV: Writing Business Letters Needed in the Workplace

Parts of the Business Letter

“Application letter is an example of Business letter; its part has been discussed from the previous chapter.”

Format of Business Letter

Business letter refers to any written communication that is used for business purposes. Various formats in drafting letter may consider. The following formats are commonly used.

Block Format

When writing business letters, you must pay special attention to the format and font used. The most common layout of a business letter is known as block format. Using this format, the entire letter is left justified and single spaced except for a double space between paragraphs.

The diagram illustrates the Full Block Form for a business letter. It is titled "Full Block Form" and "Letterhead". The layout consists of seven numbered sections: 1. Date Line, 2. Inside Address, 3. Salutation, 4. Body of the letter, 5. Complimentary Close, 6. Signature Line, and 7. Notations. All sections are left-aligned.

Modified Block

Another widely utilized format is known as modified block format. In this type, the body of the letter and the sender's and recipient's addresses are left justified and single-spaced. However, for the date and closing, tab to the center point and begin to type.

The diagram illustrates the Modified Block Form for a business letter. It is titled "Modified Block Form" and "Letterhead". The layout consists of seven numbered sections: 1. Date Line, 2. Inside Address, 3. Salutation, 4. Body of the Letter, 5. Complimentary Close, 6. Signature Line, and 7. Notations. Sections 1 and 5 are centered, while sections 2, 3, 4, 6, and 7 are left-aligned.

Semi-Block

The final, and least used, style is semi-block. It is much like the modified block style except that each paragraph is indented instead of left justified.

The diagram illustrates the Semi-Block Form for a business letter. It is titled "Semi-Block Form" and "Letterhead". The layout consists of seven numbered sections: 1. Date Line, 2. Inside Address, 3. Salutation, 4. Body of the Letter, 5. Complimentary Close, 6. Signature Line, and 7. Notations. Sections 1, 2, 3, 5, 6, and 7 are left-aligned, while section 4 (Body of the Letter) is indented.

Other Formats

The image displays three distinct formats for business letters, each within a rectangular frame.

- Indented Form or Traditional Form:** This format is titled "Indented Form or Traditional Form". It features a "Letterhead" at the top. Below it, the components are numbered and indented: 1. Heading, 2. Inside Address, 3. Salutation, 4. Body of the Letter, 5. Complimentary Close, 6. Signature Line, and 7. Notations.
- Hanging Style:** This format is titled "Hanging Style". It also has a "Letterhead" at the top. The components are numbered and hanging: 1. Heading, 2. Inside Address, 3. Salutation, 4. Body of the Letter, 5. Complimentary Close, 6. Signature Line, and 7. Notations.
- Memorandum Style:** This format is titled "Memorandum Style". It features a "Letterhead" at the top. Below it, the components are numbered and indented: 1. Date Line, FROM: TO: SUBJECT: (all indented), 4. Body of the Letter, 5. Complimentary Close, 6. Signature Line, and 7. Notations.

Types of Business Letter

Sales letter-The purpose of this is to get the reader to do something that includes strong calls to action.

Order Letter-Order letters are sent by consumers or businesses to a manufacturer, retailer or wholesaler to order goods or services. Payment is sometimes included with the letter.

Compliant Letter- letter complaining to a business may be the deciding factor on whether your complaint is satisfied.

Adjustment letter- This is commonly sent in response to a claim or complaint.

Inquiry Letter-It asks a question or elicits information from the recipient.

Follow-up Letter- Usually sent after some type of initial communication.

Letter of Recommendation-This type of letter is usually from a previous employer or professor, and it describes the sender's relationship with and opinion of the job seeker.

Acknowledgment Letters- acts as simple receipts; this is being sent to let other know that they have received a prior communication.

Letter of Resignations- this is being sent if an employee plans to leave his job, in many case employees also details reason for leaving the company.

CHAPTER V: Use the Best Job Search Engines for Work

Where we can get a job?

Finding job isn't easy at all, the competition become tighter and tighter that the fittest will survive. How can job hunting become easy? What Engines can we use to make it easier and convenient?

Applying the principle discussed in this module is just a first step to make, as we job hunt. Integration of technology serves as one of the easiest tools that make this hunting easy. Social media offers various ads where job make available for all, applicant must equip himself with knowledge to search job over the internet. Most vacant positions are posted in the internet and various websites for job hunting (legit sites) may be considered. Employers sometimes use internet in looking for an applicant, thus the knowledge of using the computers is now very vital.

Your Task!!!

This Module III requires you to make your own application/Cover letter considering the above lessons. In addition, this must be attached with your self-made resume.

<i>Congratulations for completing this Module III</i>
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